The 2026-XJ Daily

Op-ed: what the physics says

HEADLINE · YOUR CLAIM

MY ARGUMENT

I predict ____ based on ____. My model assumes ____. Point to your own work.

THE EVIDENCE BOX

Paste or copy your key calculation and sketch here.

THE LIMITS

The result is limited by ____. A range is not a probability.

PHYSICS vs. DECISION

What can the physics decide? What needs people to decide?

MY REVISION

One step I changed after feedback, and how it changed my result:

DEFEND 1 2 3

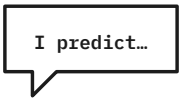
UNIT 1 COLOR CODE ☐ green speeding up ☐ red slowing down ☐ yellow steady · balanced ☐ blue position · displacement ☐ purple velocity ☐ orange forces pencil · everything else

Talk it through: defend your prediction

Language goal: I can **defend** and **revise** my answer.

DIRECTIONS · Partner A and B read their lines aloud. Listen, then write. Switch each round.

ROUND 1 · SHARE YOUR PREDICTION

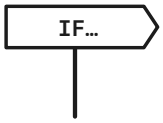


A ASKS "Where will it be, and how sure are you?"

B SAYS "I predict ____ m, with a range of ____ to ____ m."

A CHECKS "Which measurement or graph supports it? Point to it."

ROUND 2 · SWITCH · WHAT DID YOU TREAT AS TRUE?

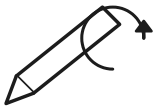


B ASKS "What does your calculation treat as true?"

A SAYS "I treated ____ as true. If that changes, my answer would ____."

B ADDS "I want to add one limit: ____."

ROUND 3 · BOTH · REVISE



A "After listening, I want to change ____ because ____."

B "My prediction is stronger now because ____."

LISTENING LOG · MY PARTNER SAID…

NOW I WRITE IT MYSELF

My final prediction and why…

Stems: I agree because… · Can you say that again? · What does ___ mean? · I want to add…

DEFEND (1) (2) (3)

UNIT 1 COLOR CODE ☐ green speeding up ☐ red slowing down ☐ yellow steady · balanced ☐ blue position · displacement ☐ purple velocity ☐ orange forces pencil · everything else

Mic check: drop the Unit 1 verse

Every bar must be true physics. Your partner fact-checks each line.

22 W

MUST INCLUDE

- one motion idea (x, v, a)
- one force idea (ΣF, F = ma)
- a prediction with a range
- a limit of the model

RHYME BANK

force / course · range / change · mass / fast / last · net / set / yet · claim / aim / same · proof / truth

THE VERSE · 8 BARS (v = fact-checked)

BAR	LYRIC (4 beats)	v
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		
6		
7		
8		

PROVE ONE BAR

Pick a bar with a number. Show the math.

FACT-CHECKER

Checked by ____ · bars fixed ____

DEFEND 1 2 3

UNIT 1 COLOR CODE ☐ green speeding up ☐ red slowing down ☐ yellow steady · balanced ☐ blue position · displacement ☐ purple velocity ☐ orange forces pencil · everything else

Pitch your recommendation

The Tank is the city council. You have 60 seconds and your transfer-task evidence.

22 Z

SLIDE 1 · THE PREDICTION

Central value ____ · range ____ to ____ · model ____

SLIDE 2 · THE EVIDENCE

Your strongest calculation or graph:

SLIDE 3 · THE LIMITS

What the model leaves out:

THE PITCH · 60 SECONDS

"Council members, our physics model predicts ____ under the assumption that ____. The range is ____, so we recommend ____. Physics can tell you ____, but deciding ____ also depends on cost, feasibility, and priorities."

SHARK QUESTION

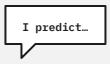
"How sure are you?" Your answer – without calling the range a probability:

DEFEND 1 2 3

UNIT 1 COLOR CODE ☐ green speeding up ☐ red slowing down ☐ yellow steady · balanced ☐ blue position · displacement ☐ purple velocity ☐ orange forces pencil · everything else

Say it, then write it: defend it

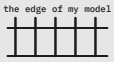
Language goal: I can **defend** a claim.



claim
afirmación · afirmação
what I say is true



evidence
evidencia · evidência
numbers, graphs, sketches



limit
límite · limite
what the model leaves out



revise
revisar · revisar
fix and improve

English · Spanish · Portuguese. My home language: _____

1 · READ AND FILL · WORD BANK: claim · evidence · reasoning · limit · revise

My ____ is the prediction. My ____ is my calculation and sketch. My ____ explains why they connect.

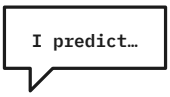
Every model has a ____. After feedback, I ____ my work.

2 · SAY IT TO A PARTNER, THEN WRITE IT



I predict ____ based on ____ .
My model assumes ____, and it is limited by ____ .

3 · SOLVE WITH THE STEPS



Your transfer task: state your prediction and range.

STEP 1 · CLAIM	STEP 2 · EVIDENCE	STEP 3 · LIMIT
"I predict ____."	"Look at my ____."	"It leaves out ____."

4 · EXPLAIN IT · CHOOSE A FRAME

☐ At first I thought ____. Now my evidence shows ____ .

☐ A skill I can use on my own is ____ .

☐ I still need practice with ____ .

I said it ☐ · I wrote it ☐

DEFEND 1 2 3

UNIT 1 COLOR CODE ☐ green speeding up ☐ red slowing down ☐ yellow steady · balanced ☐ blue position · displacement ☐ purple velocity ☐ orange forces pencil · everything else

Peer review: settle the defense

22 I

DIRECTIONS · Classmates disagree about how to defend a prediction. Who is right?

ROUND 1

ANA
"My number is right, so I don't need to show work."

BEN
"A correct-looking number doesn't show your reasoning. Point to the evidence."

Who's right? _____ · Evidence: _____

Fixed claim: _____

ROUND 2

KAI
"Our 5 ± 1 m means there's a 50% chance of 5 m."

LU
"It's a bound from our errors, not a probability."

Who's right? _____ · Evidence: _____

Fixed claim: _____

ROUND 3

MAYA
"If my partner finds a mistake, I just copy their answer."

RAJ
"Show the corrected step yourself and explain how it changes later results."

Who's right? _____ · Evidence: _____

Fixed claim: _____

YOUR TURN · WRITE A TRAP

Write a claim about today's idea that sounds right but is wrong. Trade and settle it.

DEFEND 1 2 3

UNIT 1 COLOR CODE ☐ green speeding up ☐ red slowing down ☐ yellow steady · balanced ☐ blue position · displacement ☐ purple velocity ☐ orange forces pencil · everything else